

Project Intake Sheet

Enterprise Franchise Onboarding & Partner Portal Implementation

Executive Summary

The Enterprise Franchise Onboarding & Partner Portal Implementation project was initiated to support a strategic expansion opportunity with a large enterprise merchant seeking to onboard approximately 200 franchise locations.

The client's existing engagement supported only corporate locations, limiting account growth and preventing consolidated visibility across its broader franchise network. To enable expansion, the project required the design, development, testing, and implementation of a centralized partner portal capable of supporting parent-child merchant structures, franchise onboarding workflows, and unified reporting.

The project was delivered within a compressed one-month timeline and required coordination across development, operations, sales, client success, executive leadership, and client stakeholders. Successful implementation resulted in client acceptance, onboarding of 200 franchise locations, approximately \$500K in annual recurring revenue opportunity, and the creation of a scalable partner portal framework for future multi-location merchants.

Business Problem

The client's existing engagement only supported corporate locations, creating limitations in scalability and visibility across their franchise network.

The client required a centralized partner portal that would allow corporate leadership to manage both parent and child locations through a unified dashboard while supporting franchise-specific onboarding requirements.

Without this capability, the organization would be unable to expand services to approximately 200 franchise locations, resulting in a missed revenue opportunity of approximately \$500K annually.

Project Objective

Design, build, test, and demonstrate a partner portal within a 30-day timeline that would:

- Support parent-child merchant account structures
- Enable franchise location onboarding workflows
- Provide consolidated visibility across corporate and franchise locations
- Integrate with existing platform functionality
- Obtain executive and client stakeholder approval
- Enable onboarding of approximately 200 franchise locations

Business Value / Strategic Importance

The project represented a significant growth opportunity by enabling expansion from a corporate-only relationship into a broader franchise network.

Successful completion would:

- Generate approximately \$500K in annual recurring revenue
- Create a competitive differentiator through a unique partner portal capability
- Establish a scalable framework for supporting future multi-location merchants
- Improve operational visibility and merchant account management capabilities

Project Constraints

Timeline Constraint

The project required completion within one month, including:

- Requirements gathering
- Design and development
- Testing
- Executive review
- Client demonstration
- Stakeholder acceptance

Budget Constraint

Approved development budget:

\$50,000

Resource Constraints

The project required coordination across multiple departments while maintaining existing operational responsibilities.

Project Scope

In Scope

- Development of a partner portal dashboard
- Parent-child merchant hierarchy functionality
- Franchise onboarding workflow enhancements
- Integration of corporate and franchise locations
- Portal testing and validation
- Executive demonstration
- Client stakeholder acceptance
- Preparation for onboarding approximately 200 franchise locations

Out of Scope

- Full redesign of the entire client portal platform
- Redesigning all merchant MID structures to conform to existing onboarding standards
- Broader platform changes unrelated to franchise onboarding requirements
- Development of additional functionality outside the partner portal requirements

Key Stakeholders

<u>Stakeholder</u>	<u>Role</u>	<u>Responsibility / Interest</u>
Client Stakeholders	Primary customer stakeholder	Validate solution meets franchise onboarding requirements and approve implementation
CEO / Executive Leadership	Executive sponsor	Provide strategic direction and final internal approval
Development Team	Solution delivery team	Design, develop, test, and implement portal functionality
Head Developer	Technical lead	Manage development approach and technical work breakdown
Operations Team	Operational stakeholder	Validate onboarding workflows and test MID functionality
Sales Team	Commercial stakeholder	Support demo preparation and value presentation
Client Relations Team	Project coordination	Manage stakeholder communication and project execution

Project Approach / Delivery Methodology

The project followed an incremental delivery approach consisting of four major phases:

1. Requirements & Planning
2. Design & Development
3. Testing & Validation
4. Demonstration & Stakeholder Acceptance

The incremental approach allowed stakeholders to review progress, identify issues early, and align functionality with business requirements throughout execution.

Project Timeline & Milestones

Week 1 — Requirements & Project Planning

Key Activities:

- Defined project requirements and business objectives
- Confirmed \$50,000 budget and one-month delivery timeline
- Identified stakeholder responsibilities
- Coordinated operational requirements related to MID onboarding
- Established development workstreams and incremental delivery approach

Key Deliverables:

- Defined scope
- Development requirements
- Stakeholder alignment
- Initial work breakdown structure

Week 2 — Development & Solution Build

Key Activities:

- Designed and developed partner portal functionality
- Built parent-child merchant hierarchy capabilities
- Created franchise onboarding workflow enhancements
- Conducted daily development progress reviews

Key Deliverables:

- Initial partner portal build
- Core onboarding functionality

Week 3 — Testing & Validation

Key Activities:

- Tested portal functionality
- Integrated corporate and franchise location structures
- Validated onboarding workflows
- Coordinated development and operations testing activities

Key Deliverables:

- Tested portal functionality
- Identified and resolved technical issues
- Prepared demonstration environment

Week 4 — Executive Review, Client Demo & Acceptance

Key Activities:

- Presented solution to executive leadership
- Incorporated executive feedback
- Refined demonstration approach
- Presented final solution to client stakeholders
- Obtained approval for franchise expansion

Key Deliverables:

- Approved partner portal solution
- Stakeholder acceptance
- Franchise onboarding readiness

Key Risks, Issues, and Constraints

Risks

<u>Risk</u>	<u>Impact</u>	<u>Response</u>
First implementation of partner portal capability	Increased technical uncertainty	Established incremental development approach and frequent stakeholder reviews
Integration complexity with existing platform	Potential timeline delays	Coordinated closely with development team and prioritized critical functionality
Franchise MID structures differed from existing onboarding model	Required additional development effort	Created customized onboarding workflow requirements

Issues Encountered

Portal Integration Challenges

The new partner portal experienced integration challenges with existing client portal functionality, requiring troubleshooting and additional development efforts.

MID Structure Compatibility

Franchise locations operated under different MID structures than existing onboarding processes supported, requiring development of an alternative onboarding approach.

Executive Demonstration Feedback

The initial demonstration did not receive executive approval, requiring revisions to the demo approach and additional stakeholder alignment before final acceptance.

Project Deliverables

The project successfully delivered:

- New partner portal dashboard
- Parent-child merchant hierarchy functionality
- Franchise onboarding workflow
- Consolidated corporate and franchise visibility
- Client demonstration and acceptance process
- Framework for future multi-location merchant onboarding

Project Manager Responsibilities

Project Leadership & Governance

- Owned cross-functional coordination across development, operations, sales, leadership, client success, and client stakeholders
- Served as primary point of accountability for timeline management, communication, and stakeholder alignment

Requirements & Scope Management

- Translated business requirements into development tickets and feature requests
- Coordinated requirements related to parent-child hierarchy, onboarding workflows, and reporting visibility

Execution Management

- Led daily development standups
- Tracked progress, identified blockers, and maintained alignment with project timeline
- Coordinated development and operations teams during testing activities

Stakeholder Communication

- Provided project updates to executive leadership and client stakeholders
- Partnered with sales and leadership to prepare demonstration materials and stakeholder messaging

Acceptance & Rollout Management

- Coordinated internal executive approval
- Managed client demonstration process
- Secured stakeholder acceptance and supported rollout planning for 200 franchise locations

Project Outcomes & Success Metrics

The project successfully achieved the following outcomes:

- Delivered a partner portal capability supporting parent-child merchant structures and consolidated merchant visibility
- Achieved stakeholder acceptance from executive leadership and the client
- Enabled onboarding of approximately 200 franchise locations
- Helped unlock approximately \$500K in annual recurring revenue
- Created a reusable partner portal framework for future multi-location merchants
- Expanded internal onboarding capabilities to support more complex merchant structures

Lessons Learned

Initial lessons identified from the project include:

- Early technical discovery is critical when integrating new functionality with existing platforms
- Stakeholder alignment should occur continuously throughout development, not only during final approval
- Incremental delivery and frequent feedback loops reduce risk during complex implementations
- Understanding operational workflows early prevents downstream onboarding challenges
- Executive expectations should be validated before final demonstrations to avoid rework